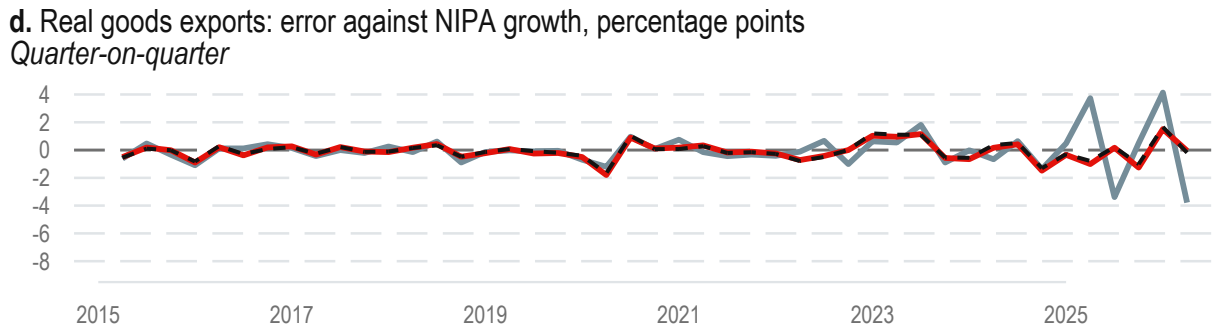
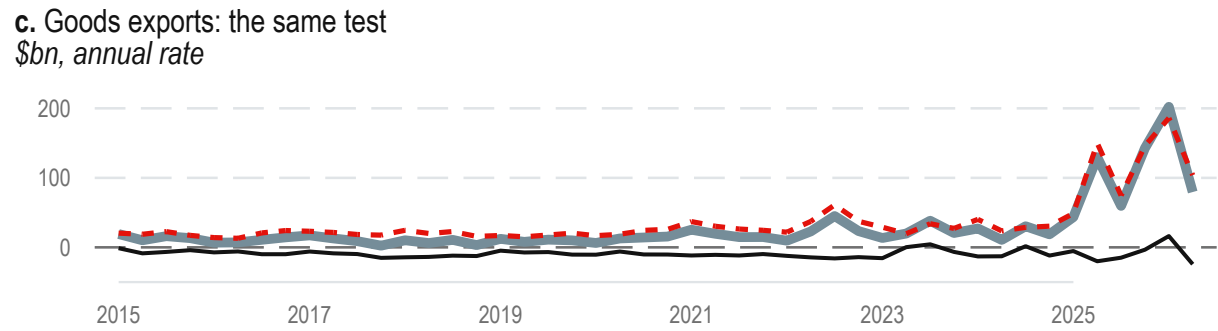
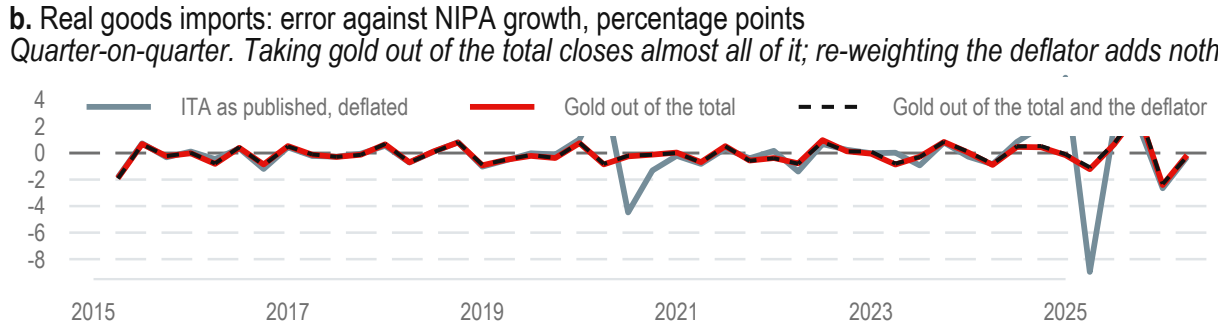
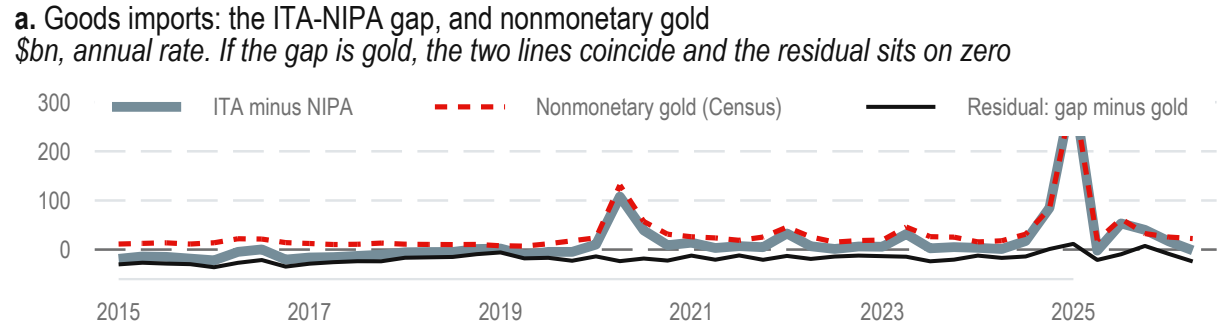




BEA publishes the same trade twice, and the difference between the two is gold

The International Transactions Accounts include nonmonetary gold; the national accounts exclude it. Nothing here is fitted



This is the one check in this project that does not rest on a counterfactual of our own construction. BEA publishes goods trade on two bases that differ in exactly the way that matters, and the gold figure subtracted from the ITA total is a third source - Census customs data. Left: the ITA goods total minus the NIPA goods total, drawn against nonmonetary gold itself. The gap IS gold - the two lines coincide at a correlation of 0.99 and the residual stays flat - and removing gold cuts the gap's standard deviation from \$54bn to \$9bn on imports and from \$39bn to \$7bn on exports. In 2025Q1 the raw gap was \$329bn at an annual rate and \$12bn remained after removing gold, on a base above \$3,600bn. The levels are not plotted: on a \$3,300bn base the wedge is under 1% for most of the sample and two level lines would sit on top of each other.

Right: the error against NIPA's own real growth. The first adjustment does nearly all the work - import RMSE falls from 2.07pp to 0.86pp and the correlation with NIPA rises from 0.90 to 0.98 - and re-weighting the deflator on top adds nothing on imports and a sliver on exports. That ordering is worth stating plainly: gold reached 10.5% of the goods import TOTAL but sits in the price index at about 1%, so removing a 10% item from the numerator dominates re-weighting a 1% one. The deflator bias measured elsewhere in this folder is real and worth about two index points over six years, but it is the smaller of the two channels.

The residual - roughly 2-3% in level and 0.6pp in quarterly growth - is NOT gold. The ITA series here is deflated with a Lowe index and NIPA is chain-Fisher over a different basket, and MXPI does not price military goods, used goods or art. Those gaps are permanent and are not meant to close. Quarters are annualised from monthly means rather than summed, because BLS published no October 2025 index and summing would understate that quarter by a third. Source: Bureau of Economic Analysis (ITA and NIPA); Bureau of Labor Statistics; US Census Bureau.